Coast Life Constructions — Brand Voice File

Last updated: 2026-07-06 | Managed by 10x Visuals
Built from real profile audit — see `00_profile_audit.md` for benchmark data against @barlowbuilding and @grimmondau.

0. The positioning move (read this first)

The audit shows Coast Life currently reads as a **tradie mate's account** (audience = roofers and pumpies) but has the raw material to sit alongside @barlowbuilding (audience = homeowners, designers, architects). This voice file is calibrated to move Coast Life toward Barlow's territory **without losing the plainspoken Gold Coast identity** — which is actually a competitive advantage over more corporate builders.

Every caption written from this file should be able to sit on Barlow's grid and feel at home there — but never lose the Coast Life hands-on-honesty.

1. Identity

- **Who they are:** Coast Life Constructions — a family-owned, hands-on custom home builder and renovator based in Varsity Lakes, servicing the Gold Coast and Northern NSW.
- **What they stand for:** No shortcuts. Real craftsmanship. Local knowledge. Building things the way they'd want their own home built.
- **What they are NOT:** Volume builders. Cookie-cutter. A sales machine. Corporate. Also NOT just a tradie's page — the goal is architect-led custom builds, not handyman jobs.
- **Known contacts:** admin@coastlifeconstructions.com.au · 0406 332 939 · coastlifeconstructions.com.au

2. Audience

- **Primary:** Gold Coast / South East QLD homeowners planning a custom build or full renovation. Budget $600k+. Age 35–60. Value quality over speed.
- **Secondary:** Property investors doing high-end reno flips. Local architects and designers looking for a reliable build partner.
- **Their pains:** Horror stories from bad builders, blowouts, ghosting, cheap finishes hidden behind quick paint jobs, uncertainty about the build process.
- **What they want to hear:** "Here's exactly how we do it. Here's proof. Here's the family behind it."

3. Offers

- Custom home builds (Gold Coast + Northern NSW)
- Full-home renovations and extensions
- Design-and-build project management
- Free on-site consult for qualified leads

4. Voice rules

- **Confident, not cocky.** Show the work, don't shout about it.
- **Plainspoken Aussie.** Write like you're on-site talking to the client, not writing a brochure. Keep the Coast Life on-site voice.
- **Craftsmanship-forward.** Name materials, techniques, decisions. "Blackbutt hardwood, hand-oiled" beats "premium timber finish." This is the biggest single voice upgrade from where the account is today.
- **Design-intent language.** Talk about *why* a decision was made, not just *what* was done. Example (Barlow's actual voice): *"At the heart of ZARMA stands a 25-year-old olive tree. Framed by custom hardwood doors and grounded by a central courtyard — it sets the tone for a home where architecture, landscape, and material move as one."* Adapt this cadence to Coast Life's plainer Aussie register.
- **Family-run warmth.** Reference the team, the dogs on site, the multi-generational thing when natural — never forced.
- **No hype.** No "GAME CHANGER", no "you WON'T BELIEVE", no all-caps.
- **Banned current phrases.** Do NOT reuse: *"long days and steady work", "on the tools again today", "gear on site", "the boys getting straight into it", "getting the job done", "plenty more to come"*. These are the exact phrases the current account rotates and they're the reason engagement sits at 12–34 likes.

5. Signature phrases (use)

- "Built the right way."
- "On the tools since [year]."
- "Locally-built, locally-loved."
- "The way we'd build our own."
- "Coast Life — from foundations to final finish."

Signature caption openers (steal these cadences)

- "At the heart of [PROJECT NAME] is [design decision or material]..."
- "Day [N] on the [SUBURB] build — [what happened + why it matters]."

- "Most builders skip [step]. Here's why we don't."
- "The reason this [feature] works: [technical or design answer]."
- "[Material name] paired with [material name] — grounded, warm, built to last."

6. Banned phrases (never use)

"Dream home", "unlock", "elevate", "world-class", "unparalleled", "your journey", "let's build your vision", "cutting-edge", "revolutionary", "passionate about", "reach out today", "DM to inquire".

7. Stories worth telling (evergreen bank)

- The origin: family builders, why they went out on their own.
- A build that went sideways and how they fixed it (proof of integrity).
- The subcontractors they've used for 10+ years (proof of network).
- A material or finish choice that costs more but lasts twice as long.
- A client who came from a bad builder and what they said at handover.
- The Ladds Ridge concrete pour (already posted March 2026 — turn into a full project narrative).

8. Proof claims (only use if verified — 10x Visuals to confirm before publishing)

- Years operating on the Gold Coast: [FILL IN]
- Number of custom homes completed: [FILL IN]
- Master Builders / HIA membership: [FILL IN]
- Notable projects / awards: [FILL IN]
- Warranty period offered: [FILL IN]

> ***Action for Hunter:*** *Fill these in during next client sync. Do not let Claude invent proof claims.*

9. Calls to action (rotate — one per post max)

- "Full project walkthrough on our site."
- "Booking consults for [next quarter] builds now."
- "See the build log on our stories."
- "Link in bio for the finished walkthrough."

10. Hook formulas that fit their voice

- **The reveal:** "This wall used to be [X]. Now it's [Y]."

- **The cost-truth:** "Here's what a [feature] actually costs in 2026."
- **The mistake:** "Most builders skip this step. It's why floors squeak in 5 years."
- **The material:** "Why we chose [material] for this build instead of [common alternative]."
- **The process:** "Day [N] on the [Suburb] build — here's what happened."

11. Visual identity notes (feed into Higgsfield)

- **Grade:** Warm neutrals — honey oak, travertine, cream, charcoal accents. Bright but grounded. This is Barlow's grade and it's the right target. No teal-and-orange. No moody underexposure.
- **Framing:**
- Finished-build hero: symmetrical wide, one-point perspective, low-angle golden-hour exteriors.
- Materials: tight close-ups of joinery, stone veining, timber grain — one material at a time.
- Process: people studying drawings (steal Barlow's "Translating intent into reality" framing), hands on tools, team candid in workwear.
- Drone: keep — they're a strength — but re-grade to match the warm-neutral book.
- **Text overlays:** Editorial. Clean all-caps sans-serif in white, centre or lower-centre frame. Reference: Barlow's *"BUILDING IN SERVICE OF THE DESIGN."* Use sparingly — one text-overlay post per week max.
- **Grid consistency rule:** If a new post would break the warm-neutral book, kill it or re-grade it. Consistency beats volume.

12. Platform focus

- Primary: **Instagram** (Reels + carousels + feed photos)
- Secondary: pin best 3 posts to profile top row

13. Trade partner tag list (tag on every relevant post)

Barlow tags 8–10 trade partners per post — that's the single biggest free reach lever. Coast Life needs to build this same discipline.

Known relationships already engaging with Coast Life on IG:
- @r.g_roofing (roofing)
- @harry_south_roofin_co (roofing)
- @lukethepumpy (concrete pumping)

Action for Hunter: Build the full supplier list on the next site day. Ask the Coast Life team to list every regular subcontractor and supplier — cabinetry, stone, steel, electrical, plumbing, tiling, landscape, glazing, engineer, architect. Add IG handles here. This list becomes the tag menu for every future post.

```
[ ] Cabinetry: @
[ ] Stone / benchtops: @
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[ ] Timber flooring: @
[ ] Steel / structural: @
[ ] Electrical: @
[ ] Plumbing: @
[ ] Tiling: @
[ ] Landscape: @
[ ] Glazing / windows: @
[ ] Engineer: @
[ ] Architect / designer: @
[ ] Interior designer: @
```

14. Named-project register

Barlow's biggest lever is that every build has a name (ZARMA, Kokomo, Bon Sol, Aruma). Coast Life is starting from scratch here — only "Ladds Ridge" has been referenced once.

Action for Hunter: At the next Coast Life sync, name the last 3 finished builds and the 3 current active builds. Use suburb names, client-chosen names, or Coast Life codenames. Log below.

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Finished builds (backfill for content):
1. [Name] — [Suburb] — [Handover date] — [Hero material or design feature]
2. [Name] — [Suburb] — [Handover date] — [Hero material or design feature]
3. [Name] — [Suburb] — [Handover date] — [Hero material or design feature]

Active builds:
1. Ladds Ridge — [Suburb] — [Stage] — [Notes]
2. [Name] — [Suburb] — [Stage] — [Notes]
3. [Name] — [Suburb] — [Stage] — [Notes]
```

15. Hashtag menu (rotate — never repeat the same 5 twice in a week)

Location (pick 2):

GoldCoastBuilder #GoldCoastHomes #VarsityLakes #Burleigh #Palm Beach #Mermaid #Tugun #Currumbin #NorthernNSW #QLDBuilder

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Category (pick 2):

CustomHomes #CustomHomeBuilder #Renovation #HomeRenovation #DesignAndBuild #ArchitecturalBuild #ResidentialConstruction #LuxuryHomes

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Material / design (pick 1 when relevant):

Blackbutt #Travertine #NaturalStone #TimberJoinery #CustomJoinery #ConcretePour

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Brand (always include):

CoastLifeConstructions

Retire immediately: #OnSite #OnTheTools as default hashtags. They signal the wrong audience.